Northwind Labs Employee Handbook

Page 1 - Welcome and Working Hours

Welcome to Northwind Labs. This handbook describes the policies that apply to every employee. Policy ID HR-001. Owner: People Operations.

Working hours. Our core collaboration hours are 10:00 to 16:00 in your local time zone. Outside core hours you may organise your day flexibly, provided your team agrees on coverage.

Hybrid work. Employees are expected in the office three days per week: Tuesday, Wednesday and Thursday. Fully remote arrangements require approval from your department head and People Operations.

Probation. New employees complete a 90-day probation period with check-ins at 30, 60 and 90 days.

Time Off and Leave

Annual leave. Full-time employees receive 20 days of paid annual leave per calendar year, plus public holidays. Part-time employees receive leave pro rata. Up to 5 unused days may be carried over into the next year; carried-over days expire on March 31.

Requesting leave. Request leave in the HR portal (Workday) at least two weeks in advance for absences longer than three days.

Sick leave. Employees receive 10 days of paid sick leave per year. A doctor’s note is required for absences longer than three consecutive days.

Parental leave. Primary caregivers receive 16 weeks of fully paid parental leave; secondary caregivers receive 6 weeks. Parental leave can be taken within 12 months of the birth or adoption.

Code of Conduct

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Respect. Northwind does not tolerate harassment, discrimination or retaliation of any kind.

Conflicts of interest. Outside employment or investments that compete with Northwind must be disclosed to your manager and the Legal team.

Gifts. Employees may accept gifts from vendors worth up to $100 per year. Anything above that must be declined or reported to Legal.

Speaking up. Concerns can be raised with your manager, People Operations, or anonymously through the Ethics Hotline at ethics.northwind.example, available 24/7.

Benefits

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Health insurance. Northwind pays 90% of medical, dental and vision premiums for employees and 75% for dependants. Coverage starts on your first day.

Retirement. Northwind matches 401(k) contributions dollar for dollar up to 4% of base salary, vesting immediately.

Learning budget. Every employee has a learning and development budget of $1,500 per year for courses, books and conferences. Unused budget does not roll over.

Wellness. A $50 monthly wellness stipend can be used for gym memberships, fitness classes or mental-health apps.